

D739

Student Teaching I in Special Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A seven-year-old with autism screams and drops to the floor when the class goes to an unplanned assembly. He is a strong reader and likes the color green. The resource room is next to the gym. What support would most likely prevent this?

- A. Keep him out of all assemblies.
- B. Give him green paper during the assembly.
- C. Tell him verbally just as the class leaves.
- D. A visual schedule reviewed each morning, with changes shown and previewed ahead of time.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student's visual schedule works well, but tomorrow a substitute will teach. What should the teacher do based on the same principle?

- A. Add the change to the schedule and preview it with the student ahead of time.
- B. Remove the schedule for the day.
- C. Have him stay home.
- D. Say nothing so he is not worried.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A fifth grader in a resource room earns stars for finishing tasks, but her work has dropped. She traded stars for stickers at first, but now says stickers are babyish. The room recently got new carpet. What should change first?

- A. Let her sit on the new carpet as a reward.
- B. End the system and use only punishment.
- C. Give stars more often, with the same stickers.
- D. Ask her what she would like to earn and update the backup reinforcers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A token system has worked for months and a student now meets his goals steadily. What is the next step?

- A.** Add more tokens to keep him going.
- B.** Switch to a different token.
- C.** Gradually thin the tokens while keeping specific praise.
- D.** Stop all tokens and praise at once.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A special education student teacher is moving lessons to the class learning platform. One student is blind and uses a screen reader; another is deaf. The platform has a new logo, and many parents use phones. What must the materials include?

- A.** A phone-friendly layout.
- B.** Captions only.
- C.** Just post the files; being online makes them accessible.
- D.** Alt text for images, screen-reader-friendly files, and captions on videos.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A middle school math teacher asks the special education student teacher, “Is there anything I need to know about the new student with an IEP?” The student plays in the band and moved from a nearby town. What should the student teacher do?

- A.** Tell the band director too, to be safe.
- B.** Make sure the math teacher knows the accommodations and responsibilities she must carry out, following the school’s process.
- C.** Send the full evaluation report to all staff.
- D.** Say nothing because IEPs are confidential.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A parent volunteer asks the student teacher which students in the class have IEPs. What is the right response?

- A.** Tell her to ask the students.
- B.** Share only disability types.
- C.** Politely decline to share, since the volunteer does not need that information.
- D.** Share the names, since the volunteer works in the room.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A student's IEP goal says she will identify coins with 80% accuracy across three sessions. This week she was correct on 16 of 20 trials Monday, 14 of 20 Wednesday, and 18 of 20 Friday. The trials were done at a table by the window. Has she met the goal?

- A.** No, because Wednesday was 70%, below 80%.
- B.** Yes, because her average is 80%.
- C.** Yes, because Friday was 90%.
- D.** No, because she needed 20 of 20.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student needs at least 80% on 15 trials. What is the least number correct that meets it?

- A.** 3
- B.** 8
- C.** 12
- D.** 13

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A fifteen-year-old with an intellectual disability reads at about a second-grade level. The student teacher plans to use picture books about baby animals. The student has a part-time job at a car wash and follows a basketball team. What is a better choice?

- A.** Keep the baby-animal books, since the level matches.
- B.** High-interest, low-readability texts written for teens at an accessible level.
- C.** Grade-level tenth-grade novels with no support.
- D.** Only basketball stats, because he likes basketball.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A high school student with a disability sends a friend request to her student teacher on a personal social media account. The student is a talented artist and just won a school award. What should the student teacher do?

- A.** Congratulate her on the award through the app.
- B.** Decline the request and keep communication on school-approved channels.
- C.** Accept it to build trust.
- D.** Accept it but never post anything.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A student teacher writes in a home log for a nine-year-old with emotional disabilities: "Terrible day. He was bad again." The family lives on a farm and has a long bus ride. What revision is best?

- A.** "He finished his math task. He left his seat 4 times during reading; we practiced asking for a break."
- B.** Mention that the long bus ride may cause behavior.
- C.** "Very bad day, sorry."
- D.** Write only good news, always.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A seven-year-old with autism screams and drops to the floor when the class goes to an unplanned assembly. ~~He is a strong reader and likes the color green. The resource room is next to the gym.~~ What support would most likely prevent this?

Target word: prevent transition distress **Decides:** Unannounced change to routine.

A	Absolute language	Exclusion is not the goal; preparation is.
B	Camouflage	Answers the color detail.
C	Dropped element	Drops the advance, visual preview.
D	Correct	Predictable routines with previewed changes reduce transition distress.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

A student's visual schedule works well, but tomorrow a substitute will teach. What should the teacher do based on the same principle?

Target word: apply to a planned change **Decides:** Preview changes.

A	Correct	Previewing keeps the day predictable.
B	Dropped element	Takes away the support when it matters most.
C	Adjacent category	Avoids the change instead of preparing him.
D	Inverted operation	Surprise is what causes distress.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A fifth grader in a resource room earns stars for finishing tasks, but her work has dropped. She traded stars for stickers at first, but now says stickers are babyish. ~~The room recently got new carpet.~~ What should change first?

Target word: fix a failing token system **Decides:** The backup reinforcer no longer motivates.

A	Camouflage	Answers the carpet detail without asking her.
B	Inverted operation	Removes reinforcement instead of fixing it.
C	Dropped element	More tokens still buy something she does not want.
D	Correct	Tokens work only if backup reinforcers are valued.

4. Answer C Concept 2 • transfer

A token system has worked for months and a student now meets his goals steadily. What is the next step?

Target word: reverse: when to fade **Decides:** Success means begin fading.

A	Inverted operation	Moves away from independence.
B	Adjacent category	Changes the form, not the dependence.
C	Correct	Fading moves toward natural reinforcement.
D	Absolute language	Abrupt removal risks loss of the behavior.

5. Answer D Concept 3

A special education student teacher is moving lessons to the class learning platform. One student is blind and uses a screen reader; another is deaf. ~~The platform has a new logo, and many parents use phones.~~ What must the materials include?

Target word: access requirements **Decides:** Screen-reader and deaf access.

A	Camouflage	Answers the phone detail.
B	Dropped element	Leaves out the screen-reader needs.
C	Absolute language	Online is not automatically accessible.
D	Correct	These features give access to the blind and deaf students.

6. Answer B Concept 4

A middle school math teacher asks the special education student teacher, "Is there anything I need to know about the new student with an IEP?" ~~The student plays in the band and moved from a nearby town.~~ What should the student teacher do?

Target word: sharing IEP information **Decides:** The math teacher implements the IEP.

A	Camouflage	Answers the band detail; share only with those who need to know.
B	Correct	Implementers must know their IEP responsibilities.
C	Adjacent category	Oversharing; need-to-know limits apply.
D	Inverted operation	Confidentiality does not bar implementers from knowing their duties.

7. Answer C Concept 4 • transfer

A parent volunteer asks the student teacher which students in the class have IEPs. What is the right response?

Target word: reverse: who may not know **Decides:** Volunteer has no need to know.

A	Inverted operation	Pushes students to disclose.
B	Dropped element	Still discloses protected information.
C	Correct	Student information is shared only with those who need it.
D	Adjacent category	Working in the room is not a need to know.

8. Answer A Concept 5

A student's IEP goal says she will identify coins with 80% accuracy across three sessions. This week she was correct on 16 of 20 trials Monday, 14 of 20 Wednesday, and 18 of 20 Friday. ~~The trials were done at a table by the window.~~ Has she met the goal?

Target word: mastery check **Decides:** Each session must meet 80%.

A	Correct	$16/20 = 80\%$, $14/20 = 70\%$, $18/20 = 90\%$; not all three meet the criterion.
B	Adjacent category	The criterion is each of three sessions, not the average.
C	Dropped element	Uses one session and drops the others.
D	Absolute language	The goal is 80%, not 100%.

9. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

A student needs at least 80% on 15 trials. What is the least number correct that meets it?

Target word: solve for count **Decides:** $0.80 \times 15 = 12$.

A	Inverted operation	That is how many may be missed.
B	Wrong stem number	Uses 80 as if it meant 8.
C	Correct	$0.80 \times 15 = 12$ correct.
D	Dropped element	Rounds up without need; 12 already equals 80%.

10. Answer B Concept 6

A fifteen-year-old with an intellectual disability reads at about a second-grade level. The student teacher plans to use picture books about baby animals. The student ~~has a part time job at a car wash and follows a basketball team~~. What is a better choice?

Target word: age-respectful material **Decides:** Match reading level while respecting age.

A	Inverted operation	Level match with age-disrespectful content.
B	Correct	Matches level while respecting age.
C	Adjacent category	Respects age but ignores the reading level.
D	Camouflage	Interest detail; not a reading plan.

11. Answer B Concept 7

A high school student with a disability sends a friend request to her student teacher on a personal social media account. ~~The student is a talented artist and just won a school award.~~ What should the student teacher do?

Target word: boundary with student **Decides:** Personal social media is outside professional channels.

A	Camouflage	Answers the award detail using the wrong channel.
B	Correct	Boundaries protect students and teachers.
C	Inverted operation	Crosses the professional boundary.
D	Dropped element	Still opens a personal channel.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A student teacher writes in a home log for a nine-year-old with emotional disabilities: "Terrible day. He was bad again." ~~The family lives on a farm and has a long bus ride.~~ What revision is best?

Target word: objective, balanced log **Decides:** Observable facts, strengths and concerns.

A	Correct	Objective, balanced, and useful.
B	Camouflage	Answers the bus detail with a guess.
C	Dropped element	Still judgmental with no facts.
D	Absolute language	Families need accurate information, including concerns.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	9	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	6	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	0	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Predictable structure and visual schedules	Many students with autism and other disabilities do best with predictable routines shown visually, with changes previewed in advance.	Assuming verbal reminders are enough, or springing changes without warning.	A student who struggles with transitions or schedule changes.
2	Token economies done well	Tokens are paired with specific praise, exchanged for backup reinforcers the student values, and faded over time toward natural reinforcement.	Giving tokens with no praise, backup items the student does not want, or never fading.	A token system that has stopped working.
3	Accessible digital materials	Online and digital materials need captions for video, alt text for images, readable structure, and compatibility with screen readers.	Assuming posting a file online makes it accessible to everyone.	A class moving materials to a learning platform.
4	Sharing IEP responsibilities with implementers	Every teacher and provider responsible for carrying out an IEP must know their specific responsibilities; information is shared on a need-to-know basis.	Keeping the IEP from general education teachers in the name of confidentiality — or sharing it with anyone.	Who may see which parts of an IEP.
5	Percent-correct data on IEP goals	Percent correct = correct trials ÷ total trials × 100, and mastery is judged against the goal's criterion across the required sessions.	Dividing by the wrong total or judging mastery from one good session.	Trial counts compared with a criterion like "80% across 3 sessions."
6	Age-respectful materials	Teach at the student's instructional level with materials that respect chronological age, such as teen-interest texts at an accessible reading level.	Using materials made for young children with older students because the reading level matches.	A teenager reading far below grade level.
7	Professional boundaries	Keep communication with students on school-approved channels and in professional roles; avoid personal social media contact and private meetings.	Believing friendly personal contact builds better relationships.	Student requests to connect outside school channels.
8	Objective home-school communication	Daily notes or logs should be objective, balanced (strengths and concerns), and useful to the family, not labels or complaints.	Writing only problems or using judgment words like "bad day."	A home-school communication log.

Course scope (public description): Student Teaching I is the first part of a two-part series and is a mandatory course for all candidates seeking initial licensure. This course provides a supervised classroom experience in a real-world setting, allowing candidates to demonstrate and reflect upon professional ethics and dispositions, collaborate with experienced teachers, and implement instructional strategies rooted in students' learning and developmental patterns. Building on the responsibilities and skills developed in Advanced Clinical, candidates will receive ongoing feedback through observations and evaluations. Feedback will encourage candidates to reflect on

their commitment to professional practices as educators, analyze and adjust teaching methods, and explore new teaching materials and methods that are culturally relevant. Additionally, the course features synchronous learning sessions that delve into communication and collaboration, accepting feedback, creating positive learning environments, and technology and online learning. Candidates must attend the required synchronous learning sessions in addition to their classroom placement.